Remote and Hybrid Working Policy

Owner: People Team

Version: 2.1

Effective: 1 January 2027

1. Purpose

This policy explains how remote and hybrid working operates at Northfield Components. It applies to all employees who have completed their probation period. Employees still in probation should work from the office unless their manager agrees otherwise in writing.

2. Principles

We trust people to do their best work where they are most effective. Remote working is a privilege that depends on meeting the needs of the business, the team and the customer. It is not a contractual right, and the company may withdraw or adjust arrangements with reasonable notice.

3. Standard arrangements

Most office-based roles follow a hybrid pattern of at least two days a week in the office. Teams should agree which days they will share and must make sure that those days are recorded in the team calendar. Roles that depend on equipment or physical presence, such as warehouse and production, are not eligible for remote working.

Employees must be available during core hours of 10:00 to 15:00 on working days. Managers must agree any changes to core hours in advance.

4. Requesting a change

An employee wishing to change their pattern must submit a request through the HR portal. The line manager must respond within ten working days. If the request is declined, the manager must give the reasons in writing. Employees may appeal to the head of department within five working days of the decision.

5. Working from abroad

Employees must not work from outside the United Kingdom for more than ten days in any calendar year without written approval from the People Team. Working abroad can create tax, immigration and data protection obligations, and approval will not be given retrospectively. Requests must be submitted at least six weeks before travel.

6. Equipment and expenses

The company will provide a laptop, monitor and headset to all hybrid employees. Employees are responsible for keeping equipment secure and must report loss or theft to IT within 24 hours. A home working allowance of £8 per week is paid for each week in which an employee works from home for at least three days.

7. Information security

Employees working remotely must use the company VPN when accessing internal systems, lock their screens when leaving the device, and never use personal email for company business. Confidential documents must not be printed at home. Any suspected data breach must be reported to the security team immediately.

8. Health and safety

Employees must complete the online display screen equipment assessment within one month of starting to work from home and repeat it annually. Managers should hold regular one to one conversations about wellbeing and workload.

9. Review

The People Team will review this policy each year. Managers must confirm to the People Team by 31 January that all team members have read and accepted it.